



# Ludmilla Vilisevic

*The Eldest Bride* · *Medium Undead (Vampire)*, *Lawful Evil* · CR 8 (3,900 XP; PB +3)

**AC** 15   **Initiative** +6 (16)   **Speed** 30 ft., Climb 30 ft.

**HP** 120 (16d8 + 48) □□□□□□□□

**STR**  
12 (+1)  
save +1

**DEX**  
16 (+3)  
save +6

**CON**  
16 (+3)  
save +3

**INT**  
20 (+5)  
save +8

**WIS**  
14 (+2)  
save +5

**CHA**  
16 (+3)  
save +3

**Skills** Arcana +8, Deception +6, Insight +5, Perception +5, Stealth +6

**Resistances** Necrotic   **Senses** Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 15

**Languages** Common, Elvish, Infernal

## TRAITS

**Spider Climb.** Walls and ceilings, no check.

**Regeneration.** Regains **10 HP** at the start of her turn if she has at least 1 HP and isn't in sunlight or running water. Radiant damage or holy water stops it at the start of her next turn.

**Bride of Strahd.** In Castle Ravenloft, when Strahd uses his lair action to pass through walls, doors and floors, she can do the same until his next lair action — if he allows it. (Level 12 only; see page 4.)

**Vampire Weaknesses.** **Forbiddance** — can't enter a home uninvited. **Running water** — 20 Acid if she ends her turn in it. **Sunlight** — *real* sunlight only (the Sunsword, a *Daylight* spell, Dawnbreak; Barovia's grey daylight doesn't count); 20 Radiant at the start of her turn, and Disadvantage on attacks and checks. **Stake** — a piercing weapon through the heart while she's Incapacitated in her coffin: Paralyzed until removed.

## ACTIONS

**Multiattack.** Two Blood Bolt attacks. She can replace one of them with a Bite.

**Blood Bolt.** *Melee or Ranged:* +8, reach 5 ft. or range 120 ft. *Hit:* 18 (3d8 + 5) Necrotic.

**Bite.** *Con save DC 14*, one creature within 5 ft. that is willing, Grappled, Incapacitated or Restrained. *Fail:* 6 (1d6 + 3) Piercing + 10 (3d6) Necrotic. HP maximum drops by the Necrotic taken; she regains that much.

**Spellcasting.** Intelligence (spell save **DC 16**, +8 to hit), no Material components.

*At will:* Disguise Self, Mage Hand, Minor Illusion

*2/day each:* Hold Person (two targets), Hideous Laughter, Web

*1/day:* Bestow Curse

## BONUS ACTIONS

**Deathless Agility.** Dash or Disengage.

## REACTIONS

**Protective Magic (3/Day).** She casts *Counterspell* or *Shield* when its trigger happens.

## APPEARANCE

Long dark hair under a **red lace veil** she never lifts, pale green eyes, a ruby choker, a red silk gown. Very still and very quiet. People forget she's in the room until she speaks.

## WHO SHE IS

The first of the three, a bride for two hundred years. A foundling from **Amn**, far beyond the mists, who stowed away in a Vistani wagon as a child and woke up in Barovia. She lived by stealing until a kind family in **Vallaki** took her in. She never felt she belonged. At eighteen she went looking for the **Amber Temple** and found **Rahadin** instead. He gave her to Strahd as a distraction. Strahd fed on her and taught her magic and manners. When she proved too clever to waste, he made her a bride.

Rahadin told her the truth: Strahd tires of every wife. So she made herself useful: his books, his errands, his eyes. She even found him the next one: disguised by magic as "the Count's agent", she went to Anastrasya's parties.

**What she wants:** to outlast his boredom. She knows Ireena is the end of all three of them. She won't cross Strahd while he's winning. If the party starts to look like winners, she'll quietly change sides. His death sets her free.

## HOW SHE FIGHTS

- Never at the front: Web or Hold Person first, then Blood Bolts from the ceiling.
- Counterspells the cleric's big heal or the sorcerer's best spell.
- Bites only what's held, webbed or laughing on the floor.
- Leaves the moment the numbers turn. She has never died for anyone.

## WHAT SHE SAYS

- *From the carriage:* "My lord. They'll miss the gates."
- *To Volenta, never louder than this:* "Enough."
- *To Ireena:* "It's nothing personal. You're the last page. After you, he stops reading."
- *The deal:* "Leave the girl behind — Krezk, the knights' hall, anywhere but the castle. I'll tell you where he sleeps, and on the day you come, the other two stay in their coffins."

## WHAT SHE CARRIES

**Illusionist's Bracers** (card 65) — taken from the Amber Temple long ago. She wears them always.

A **black iron key** to Strahd's study. She keeps his books.

A **ruby choker** (500 gp) and a **pressed red rose**, like the ones on a grave in Vallaki.

A **letter from Strahd** — see "The three letters", page 4.



# Anastrasya Karelova

*The Favourite* — or so she believes · *Medium Undead (Vampire)*, *Neutral Evil* · CR 8 (3,900 XP; PB +3)

**AC** 16 **Initiative** +4 (14) **Speed** 30 ft., Climb 30 ft.

**HP** 136 (16d8 + 64) □□□□□□□□

**STR**  
16 (+3)  
save +3

**DEX**  
18 (+4)  
save +7

**CON**  
18 (+4)  
save +4

**INT**  
14 (+2)  
save +2

**WIS**  
14 (+2)  
save +5

**CHA**  
18 (+4)  
save +7

**Skills** Deception +10, Insight +5, Perception +5, Persuasion +10

**Resistances** Necrotic **Senses** Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 15

**Languages** Common

## TRAITS

**Spider Climb.** Walls and ceilings, no check.

**Regeneration.** Regains **10 HP** at the start of her turn if she has at least 1 HP and isn't in sunlight or running water. Radiant damage or holy water stops it at the start of her next turn.

**The Favourite.** While Strahd is within 60 ft. of her, she has **Advantage on saving throws**.

**Bride of Strahd.** In Castle Ravenloft, when Strahd uses his lair action to pass through walls, doors and floors, she can do the same until his next lair action — if he allows it. (Level 12 only; see page 4.)

**Vampire Weaknesses.** **Forbiddance** — can't enter a home uninvited. **Running water** — 20 Acid if she ends her turn in it. **Sunlight** — *real* sunlight only (the Sunsword, a *Daylight* spell, Dawnbreak; Barovia's grey daylight doesn't count): 20 Radiant at the start of her turn, and Disadvantage on attacks and checks. **Stake** — a piercing weapon through the heart while she's Incapacitated in her coffin: Paralyzed until removed.

## ACTIONS

**Multiattack.** Two Claw attacks, then one Bite.

**Claw.** *Melee:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) Slashing + 7 (2d6) Necrotic. A Medium or smaller target is **Grappled** (escape DC 14).

**Bite.** *Con save DC 15*, one creature within 5 ft. that is willing, Grappled, Incapacitated or Restrained. *Fail:* 7 (1d6 + 4) Piercing + 14 (4d6) Necrotic. HP maximum drops by the Necrotic taken; she regains that much.

**Children of the Night (1/Day).** At night only. She calls **1d4 Swarms of Bats** (Swarms of Rats indoors). They arrive at the start of her next turn and obey her for 1 hour.

## BONUS ACTIONS

**Charm (Recharge 5–6).** Casts *Charm Person* (DC 15, no components). Lasts 1 hour; the target is a willing recipient of her Bite and doesn't know afterward that it was charmed.

**Deathless Agility.** Dash or Disengage.

## REACTIONS

**Shield of the Master.** When an attack hits Strahd while she is within 5 ft. of him, she takes the hit instead.

## APPEARANCE

Tall and still, with dark skin, long braids and a **gold crown** worked like a church window. An old white wedding gown, gold at the throat and wrists. She never hurries, and she never stops smiling.

## WHO SHE IS

A **Vallaki noblewoman**, famous a century ago for her parties: lavish nights in honour of a Count she had never met, whose reputation she knew perfectly well. She was beautiful, and sure it would make her his bride. At one party a veiled guest, **Ludmilla**, invited her to Castle Ravenloft. Ludmilla expected her to be horrified. Anastrasya fell in love with the place, and Strahd took her that night.

She's the strongest of the three in the old vampire gifts: the charm, the bats, the rats. She believes she's his favourite. She isn't; nobody is but Tatyana. Old families in Vallaki still remember her parties. **Lady Wachter's** great-grandmother went to them, and the Wachters have kept the faith ever since.

**What she wants:** to be first. She resents Ludmilla, who recruited her and still gives the orders. Most of all she hates Ireena, who is everything Anastrasya was supposed to be. She doesn't want Ireena dead. She wants her **ruined**, face first.

## HOW SHE FIGHTS

- Talks first. Charms the most trusting face, then has them "protect" her.
- Calls the bats before she closes in; the swarms blind the back line.
- Goes for Ireena's face. If Strahd is there, she stays at his side and takes hits for him.
- Leaves the moment it turns: "He'll hear about this."

## WHAT SHE SAYS

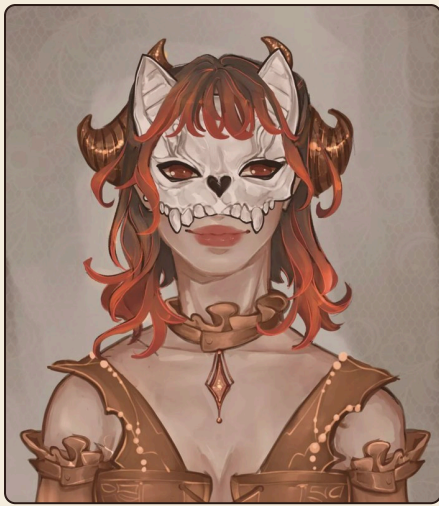
- *From the carriage:* "So that's her. I thought she'd be taller."
- *At Lady Wachter's table:* "I used to give parties in this town. For him. Before your grandmothers were born."
- *To Ireena:* "He'll tire of you too. He tires of everything but the chase."
- *Coming for her:* "Hold still. I only want the face."

## WHAT SHE CARRIES

**Ring of Protection** (card 57) — Strahd's gift to his "favourite". She never takes it off, so it drops wherever she falls, even in Vallaki.

**A gold choker** (250 gp).

**A letter from Strahd** — see "The three letters", page 4.



# Volenta Popofsky

The Youngest Bride · Medium Undead (Vampire), Chaotic Evil · CR 9 (5,000 XP; PB +4)

**AC** 15 **Initiative** +5 (15) **Speed** 40 ft., Climb 40 ft.

**HP** 150 (20d8 + 60) □□□□□□□□

**STR**  
18 (+4)  
save +4

**DEX**  
20 (+5)  
save +9

**CON**  
16 (+3)  
save +3

**INT**  
10 (+0)  
save +0

**WIS**  
10 (+0)  
save +4

**CHA**  
14 (+2)  
save +2

**Skills** Acrobatics +9, Athletics +8, Intimidation +6, Perception +4, Stealth +9

**Resistances** Necrotic **Senses** Darkvision 120 ft., Passive Perception 14

**Languages** Common

## TRAITS

**Spider Climb.** Walls and ceilings, no check.

**Regeneration.** Regains **10 HP** at the start of her turn if she has at least 1 HP and isn't in sunlight or running water. Radiant damage or holy water stops it at the start of her next turn.

**Blood Frenzy.** Advantage on attack rolls against any creature that is missing any of its Hit Points.

**Playing With Food.** The first time on each of her turns that she drops a creature to 0 HP, she leaves it at **1 HP** instead. She always does. She wants to hear them.

**Mourning Amulet.** Damage she takes hits the amulet first. It has **20 HP** □□□□. At 0 it **shatters**: she takes any leftover damage and frenzies for 1 minute: **+2 AC, double Speed, one extra Claw** on each of her turns. An unbroken amulet is back to 20 HP at dawn.

**Bride of Strahd.** In Castle Ravenloft, when Strahd uses his lair action to pass through walls, doors and floors, she can do the same until his next lair action — if he allows it. (Level 12 only; see page 4.)

**Vampire Weaknesses.** **Forbiddance** — can't enter a home uninvited. **Running water** — 20 Acid if she ends her turn in it. **Sunlight** — *real* sunlight only (the Sunsword, a *Daylight* spell, Dawnbreak; Barovia's grey daylight doesn't count): 20 Radiant at the start of her turn, and Disadvantage on attacks and checks. **Stake** — a piercing weapon through the heart while she's Incapacitated in her coffin: Paralyzed until removed.

## ACTIONS

**Multiattack.** Three Claw attacks, or two Claws and one Bite.

**Claw.** *Melee:* +9, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 5) Slashing + 7 (2d6) Necrotic. A Medium or smaller target is **Grappled** (escape DC 16).

**Bite.** *Con save DC 15*, one creature within 5 ft. that is willing, Grappled, Incapacitated or Restrained. *Fail:* 8 (1d6 + 5) Piercing + 14 (4d6) Necrotic. HP maximum drops by the Necrotic taken; she regains that much.

## BONUS ACTIONS

**Pounce.** She moves up to half her Speed toward a creature without provoking Opportunity Attacks. If she ends within 5 ft. of it, it makes a **DC 16 Strength** save or is knocked **Prone**.

**Deathless Agility.** Dash or Disengage.

## REACTIONS

**Not Yet.** When a creature within 5 ft. of her moves away, she makes one Claw attack against it.

## APPEARANCE

Small, and much younger than the other two. Copper-red hair, short curled horns, and a **white skull mask** with a heart-shaped nose and fangs. A brown lace-up gown, and a **black glass heart** on a chain that she strokes when she's nervous. Nobody has seen her without the mask in years.

## WHO SHE IS

A working girl in **Barovia village** who took men home and never let them leave. She tortured them slowly, and liked it. When the village found out, she ran to Castle Ravenloft and offered herself to Strahd, for anything he wanted. Her appetite impressed him; he sometimes admires her bloodlust as rivalling his own.

His wedding gift was the **Mourning Amulet**, a black glass heart that takes wounds for her. It was the first such thing he ever made. The **Heart of Sorrow** in his tower was built from what he learned.

**What she wants:** fun, blood, and Strahd forever. She believes he loves her and always will, so she can't accept Ireena. When Strahd looks at the girl, Volenta wants to break something. Usually someone. She pushes every limit Strahd and Ludmilla set.

## HOW SHE FIGHTS

- Pounces on the weakest-looking target and never lets go.
- Once someone is hurt, Blood Frenzy makes her relentless.
- Leaves people at 1 HP to play with — use it as tension, and as the party's chance.
- When the heart shatters she screams, then laughs — and gets faster.

## WHAT SHE SAYS

- *From the carriage:* "Can I have that one? Just a little? I'll give it back."
- "Oh, you're new! Run. Please run. It's so much better when you run."
- *Over a fallen hero:* "Not yet. Not yet. Get up."
- *About Ireena:* "He doesn't love her. He loves ME. He said so."

## WHAT SHE CARRIES

**Nine Lives Stealer** (card 56) — a trophy from a knight she played with. She doesn't fight with it: it lies in her coffin in Strahd's tomb, and the party finds it there.

The Mourning Amulet crumbles when she's destroyed. Nothing to take.

**A pouch of 23 gold-capped teeth** (230 gp). Trophies.

**A letter from Strahd** — see "The three letters", page 4.

# Running the Brides

Three wives he keeps but doesn't love — and how strong to make them as the campaign goes on

## WHAT THEY ARE

In the book they're three plain **vampire spawn** (CR 5) who sleep beside Strahd in his **tomb (K86)**, in old wedding gowns and very good jewellery; **if he's destroyed, they're free**. These sheets keep that, and add each bride's history from the r/CurseofStrahd community (u/JonathanWriting's version), her own trick, and enough strength for level 12.

**Strahd treats them as possessions.** He never gave them his full power and never will. Each one knows it. That resentment is your lever.

## HOW STRONG THEY ARE — THE LEASH

Strahd decides how far they may go, and loosens the leash as the party becomes a threat. That's how the brides get harder as the campaign goes on.

| LEVEL                                             | HIS ORDER                            | HOW TO RUN HER                                                                                                                                                                            | SHE LEAVES                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>5–6</b> · the road, Vallaki, the castle dinner | "Look. Don't touch."                 | <b>Holding back:</b> half HP; Multiattack loses one attack and the Bite; no Recharge power in round 1. Volenta's amulet still works, but if it breaks she runs home instead of frenzying. | After 2 rounds, or at the first radiant hit — escape roll. Not after the castle dinner. |
| <b>7–9</b> · the road west, Krezk                 | "Frighten them. Don't kill them."    | Full stat block. One bride per fight, with spawn or swarms.                                                                                                                               | At half HP — escape roll                                                                |
| <b>10–11</b> · the Amber Temple                   | "Do as you like — but not the girl." | Full stat block.                                                                                                                                                                          | At a quarter HP — escape roll                                                           |
| <b>12</b> · Castle Ravenloft                      | "Kill them."                         | Full stat block plus <b>Bride of Strahd:</b> through the walls with him.                                                                                                                  | Never, at home                                                                          |

| THE NUMBERS       | LEVEL 5–6                                                   | LEVEL 7–9                      | LEVEL 10–11  | LEVEL 12     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------|--------------|
| <b>Ludmilla</b>   | HP 60 · one Blood Bolt <i>or</i> one spell a turn · no Bite | HP 120 · leaves at 60          | Leaves at 30 | Full + walls |
| <b>Anastrasya</b> | HP 68 · one Claw a turn · no Bite, no bats                  | HP 136 · leaves at 68          | Leaves at 34 | Full + walls |
| <b>Volenta</b>    | HP 75 + amulet · two Claws · no Bite                        | HP 150 + amulet · leaves at 75 | Leaves at 37 | Full + walls |

**XP:** a bride driven off is worth half her XP. Destroyed, all of it.

## ESCAPING — AND DYING EARLY

When a bride decides to leave, she Dashes or Disengages (Deathless Agility) and goes up a wall, out a window or over a roof. First, check whether she can:

**She's trapped, no roll** — if she's Grappled, Restrained or Paralyzed; if there's no wall, window or door she can reach this turn; or if she's inside real sunlight (a *Daylight* spell). She fights on.

**Otherwise roll a d20 — the escape roll. 1–5:** cut off this round (a door slams, a guard's lantern, a slip on a wet roof). She fights on and rolls again next turn. **6–20:** she's gone.

**So the brides can die early.** At half HP, a cornered bride can be finished by a level 5 party, and a party that plans (a net, a grapple, *Daylight* on the only exit) can make her first appearance her last. Then see page 5.

## THE FIGHT AT LEVEL 12

| WHO                  | XP          | FOR THE PARTY + IREENA                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Any one bride        | 3,900–5,000 | Well under Low alone — and she never stays alone                                                                   |
| All three            | 12,800      | Between Low and Moderate on paper. Harder in practice: grapples, bites that cut max HP, regeneration, Counterspell |
| All three at level 9 | 12,800      | Past High — a crypt raid this early is a trap                                                                      |
| Brides + Strahd      | 27,800      | <b>Deadly.</b> Never put them in his fight                                                                         |

## WAKING THEM

- By day in their coffins they're **Incapacitated:** the stake window.
- Loud fighting, open flame near the coffins or stolen jewellery: roll a d20 per bride. On 11 or higher, she wakes.
- One bride waking wakes the others at the end of the next round.
- If Strahd waits in his tomb, deal with the brides first, by day.

## HOW THEY CAME TO HIM

| WHO                              | HOW                                                    | ANSWERS TO                        |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Ludmilla</b><br>200 years ago | Found by Rahadin near the Amber Temple                 | Strahd and Rahadin                |
| <b>Anastrasya</b>                | Recruited by Ludmilla at her own party in Vallaki      | Strahd — never Ludmilla, she says |
| <b>Volenta</b><br>the newest     | Ran to the castle after her murders in Barovia village | Nobody, if she can help it        |

## THE THREE LETTERS

Each bride carries a letter from Strahd. They are the **same letter**, word for word — only the name at the top is different:

*"My dearest \_\_\_\_, you are the only light left in this house. Everything I have done, I have done so that you would never be alone again. Wait for me. — S."*

The hand is the same as on the dinner invitation the party carried from Death House. They'll recognise it.

## USING THEIR RESENTMENT

**Ludmilla** can be bargained with. She's the one who might change sides, if the party looks like winning.

**Anastrasya** can be flattered, and baited: dangle Ireena and she'll break orders to get at her.

**Volenta** can't be reasoned with, but she can be distracted. Give her something to chase and she forgets every order.

# The Brides Across the Campaign

When each one shows up, what she says, and what changes if one of them dies

## WHERE THEY APPEAR, IN ORDER

| WHEN · WHERE                                             | WHO                        | WHAT HAPPENS                                                                                                                       | WHAT SHE SAYS                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Road to Vallaki</b> · level 5<br>Prep IV, Scene 2     | All three, in his carriage | One moment each while Strahd talks. No fight.                                                                                      | <i>"So that's her. I thought she'd be taller." · "Can I have that one?" · "My lord. They'll miss the gates."</i> |
| <b>Vallaki, days 1–3</b> · Wachterhaus                   | Anastrasya                 | Lady Wachter's house guest. Guest of honour at dinner (day 1); sleeps in the cellar by day. The party's chance to stake her early. | <i>"I used to give parties in this town. For him."</i>                                                           |
| <b>Vallaki, day 2</b> · the stolen bones                 | Ludmilla, unseen           | The "lady in the red veil" who scared Henrik. Her own grave in the churchyard, with fresh roses.                                   | —                                                                                                                |
| <b>Vallaki, day 3</b> · Festival night                   | Volenta, then Ludmilla     | Volenta leads the spawn into the church, or hunts the crowd. Two rounds, holding back. Ludmilla calls her off from the roof.       | <i>"Oh good. The fun ones." · "Volenta. Enough."</i>                                                             |
| <b>Dinner at the castle</b> · level 6<br>Future Possible | All three                  | Ludmilla serves beside Rahadin. Anastrasya plays hostess. Volenta sits too close. His word protects the guests.                    | <i>"After dinner doesn't count."</i>                                                                             |
| <b>The road west</b> · level 7                           | Volenta                    | She slips her leash and hunts them at night. Full strength; runs at half HP. A note from Strahd follows.                           | <i>"Run. Please run."</i>                                                                                        |
| <b>After Krezk</b> · level 8–9                           | Anastrasya                 | A night raid for Ireena's face, with 2 vampire spawn and her bats.                                                                 | <i>"Hold still. I only want the face."</i>                                                                       |
| <b>Amber Temple</b> · level 10–11                        | Ludmilla                   | She's studying there for Strahd. She offers the deal.                                                                              | <i>"Leave the girl behind..."</i>                                                                                |
| <b>Castle Ravenloft</b> · level 12                       | Whoever is left            | Their tomb by day, the walls by night, bridesmaids if Ireena is taken to the chapel.                                               | <i>"My turn."</i>                                                                                                |

## DEPENDING ON WHAT THE PARTY DOES

- **They skip Lady Wachter's dinner:** Anastrasya watches Ireena's window from the roof across the street instead.
- **They search Wachterhaus by day:** her coffin is behind the cult's shrine (Prep IV, "The coffin in the cellar").
- **They fight a bride early:** the escape roll (page 4) decides whether she gets away.
- **They return the bones:** Volenta can't get into the church, so she hunts the Festival crowd.
- **They refuse the castle dinner:** the brides stay in; the carriage waits all night.

- **They broke Volenta's amulet in Vallaki:** it's gone. On the road west she has no amulet.
- **Ireena is ever taken:** go straight to the chapel. The surviving brides are her bridesmaids.

## LOOT, ALL THREE

| ITEM                       | FROM             | VALUE     |
|----------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| Illusionist's Bracers (65) | Ludmilla         | very rare |
| Key to Strahd's study      | Ludmilla         | —         |
| Ring of Protection (57)    | Anastrasya       | rare      |
| Nine Lives Stealer (56)    | Volenta's coffin | very rare |
| Chokers and teeth          | all three        | 980 gp    |

## IF ONE OF THEM DIES EARLY

| IF...                                                   | STRAHD                                                                                                    | THE OTHERS                                                                                                                      | WHAT CHANGES                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Volenta</b> is destroyed                             | Insulted, not sad. A black coffin is left outside their next lodging: "You broke something of mine. — S." | Ludmilla is relieved. Anastrasya is frightened: it could be her.                                                                | No hunt on the road west. Anastrasya's raid comes a level earlier.            |
| <b>Anastrasya</b> is destroyed (staked at Wachterhaus?) | Barely reacts: "She was lovely. So was the last one."                                                     | Ludmilla sees what they're worth. Volenta rampages through the villages.                                                        | Ludmilla's deal comes early, at Krezk or Argynvostholt, and she means it.     |
| <b>Ludmilla</b> is destroyed                            | Cold fury: she kept his books and his secrets. Rahadin takes over her errands and shadows the party.      | Nobody holds Volenta back. Anastrasya thinks she's first at last, and gets reckless.                                            | No deal. Volenta attacks every few nights. Strahd knows less of what they do. |
| They <b>take Ludmilla's deal</b>                        | If he survives the castle, he finds out. She's gone the next night.                                       | She keeps the other two in their coffins on the day of the assault.                                                             | No brides in the castle fight. Ireena stays in Krezk.                         |
| <b>All three</b> are gone before the castle             | Three empty coffins in his tomb, with fresh flowers. He fights alone, and angrier.                        | —                                                                                                                               | The castle is easier. They earned it.                                         |
| <b>Strahd</b> dies, a bride survives                    | —                                                                                                         | As in the book, they're free. Ludmilla leaves the valley. Anastrasya claims the castle. Volenta hunts, with nobody to stop her. | An epilogue — or one last fight.                                              |